



Module 03 — Sacred Texts Unlocked



Module 3 of 8 — Gnostic Practices for Beginners. Complete Modules 1 and 2 first. Enrol at veilcartography.org

Module 3 — Sacred Texts Unlocked



What you will gain from this module:

- Navigate the Nag Hammadi Library and identify its major texts
- Interpret key sayings from the Gospel of Thomas
- Practise contemplative reading as a living spiritual tool
- Begin a personal sacred text journal

Duration: 3 hours · 3 lessons + 1 workbook session

Price: £4.99 · Available at veilcartography.org

Lesson 3.1 — The Nag Hammadi Discovery (30 min)

In December 1945, a young Egyptian farmer named Muhammad Ali al-Samman was digging near the cliffs of Jabal al-Tarif, close to Nag Hammadi in Upper Egypt. His mattock struck a large sealed clay jar. Inside were 13 leather-bound papyrus codices — ancient books hidden there in the 4th century CE by monks concealing them from the Church's campaign to destroy heretical texts. They had lain undisturbed for 1,700 years.

What is in the library:

The Nag Hammadi Library contains 52 texts in Coptic, translated from Greek originals:

- **The Gospel of Thomas** — 114 sayings attributed to Jesus. No narrative, no miracles. Pure teaching.
- **The Gospel of Philip** — A Valentinian text on the sacraments and the divine feminine.
- **The Apocryphon of John** — The secret teaching of John, containing the full Gnostic cosmology.
- **The Gospel of Truth** — A meditation on error and the return to the Father.
- **Thunder, Perfect Mind** — A poem in the voice of the divine feminine.
- **The Hypostasis of the Archons** — A detailed account of the Archons and the material world.

How to approach these texts: Read slowly. Sit with one passage in silence. Let it work on you. The meaning often arrives not during reading but in the quiet afterwards.

Lesson 3.2 — Gospel of Thomas Deep Dive (45 min)

The Gospel of Thomas opens: *"These are the secret sayings that the living Jesus spoke... Whoever discovers the interpretation of these sayings will not taste death."*

This is not a promise of physical immortality. It is a statement about gnosis: the one who truly understands these sayings has found something that transcends the fear of death.

Three sayings for deep study:

Saying 3: *"The Kingdom is within you and it is outside you. When you know yourselves, then you will be known..."*

The Kingdom is not a future reward. It is a present reality, accessible through self-knowledge.

Saying 22: *"When you make the two into one... the male and female into a single one... then you will enter the Kingdom."*

This is about the integration of opposites — making whole what has been divided within yourself.

Saying 70: *"If you bring forth what is within you, what you have will save you. If you do not have that within you, what you do not have within you will kill you."*

The divine spark within you is your salvation. Suppressing it is the source of all suffering.

The reading method: Choose one saying. Read it once. Put the text down. Sit in silence for five to ten minutes. Do not analyse. Simply hold the saying in awareness and notice what arises. Write what comes. Return the next day and repeat.

Lesson 3.3 — The Apocryphon of John and Other Key Texts (45 min)

The Apocryphon of John is the most complete account of Gnostic cosmology in the library. It is structured as a post-resurrection dialogue in which Christ reveals the true nature of reality — the Pleroma, the fall of Sophia, the Demiurge, and the path of return.

Key sections: the description of the Monad (the highest divine principle defined by what it is *not*); the fall of Sophia and the birth of the Demiurge; the creation of Adam and Sophia's gift of the divine spark.

Thunder, Perfect Mind is a poem in the voice of a divine feminine figure who defies all categories:

"I am the first and the last. I am the honoured one and the scorned one. I am the whore and the holy one. I am the wife and the virgin. I am the mother and the daughter..."

Read this text aloud, slowly, as a meditation. Best read once a day for a week.

Workbook 3 — Sacred Text Journal (30 min)

Exercise 1 — Five Sayings, Five Days

Choose five sayings from the Gospel of Thomas. For five consecutive days, spend ten minutes with one saying per day using the contemplative reading method.

Day 1 — Saying :

Day 2 — Saying :

Day 3 — Saying :

Day 4 — Saying :

Day 5 — Saying :

Exercise 2 — What Does This Mean in My Life Today?

Choose the saying that felt most alive this week. Write one paragraph: *What does this saying mean in my life, right now, today?*

Exercise 3 — Your Contemplative Reading Guide

Write your own simple guide for contemplative reading — the method that works for you.

Module 3 Self-Check

- ☐ I can name at least five texts in the Nag Hammadi Library
- ☐ I can explain what makes the Gospel of Thomas unusual

- ☐ I have practised contemplative reading with at least one saying
 - ☐ I have written my personal contemplative reading guide
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Next: Module 4 — Sophia: The Divine Feminine. Available at veilcartography.org

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